

AAILEEN SARWAR SYED

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IT SPECIALIST | SERVICE DESK & REMOTE SUPPORT

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

IT Support Specialist with three years of Level I and Level II experience, including two years as the sole technical resource for a 100+ user organization and an MSP role resolving 30+ weekly tickets across 15+ client environments. Skilled in Active Directory and Microsoft 365 account administration for onboarding and offboarding, Windows 10/11 troubleshooting, workstation and device deployment, IT asset tracking, and knowledge base documentation. Cut repeat support requests 80% by identifying and removing their recurring causes. Strong customer service supporting technical and non-technical users on site and remotely; TEDx speaker.

SKILLS

Help Desk & Service Desk: Level I and Level II support, ticket triage and lifecycle management from open through close, ticketing systems (Jira), incident and escalation management, queue management, walk-in, deskside and remote support, end-user training, knowledge base article creation, SOP documentation, customer service

Operating Systems & Applications: Windows 10, Windows 11, Windows Server fundamentals, Microsoft 365 (O365), Exchange, Outlook, Word, Excel, Teams, SharePoint, OneDrive, Google Workspace, Linux, web-based applications, browser troubleshooting

Identity & Access Management: Active Directory (AD), Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD), Group Policy, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), user onboarding and offboarding, account provisioning and deprovisioning, security group administration, password resets, permissions troubleshooting, access review

Hardware, Devices & Assets: Workstation setup, configuration and imaging, desktop, laptop, tablet and mobile device deployment, hardware diagnostics and component replacement, printer, monitor and peripheral support, audio visual (AV) and event technology support, asset tracking, inventory and disposition

Networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, LAN, WAN, VPN and remote access, subnetting, VLANs, firewall rules, pfSense, Cisco switches, wireless networking, Wireshark

Monitoring & Security: PRTG, Sophos, Webroot, endpoint protection, patch management, alert and log review, SIEM and IDS logging, phishing awareness, NIST CSF 2.0, PowerShell, Bash, Python, SQL, Git/GitHub

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Graduate Assistant | Lewis University

Jan 2025 - May 2026

- Supported programming and operational systems serving 200+ students per semester, 30+ external partner organizations, and a team of 20+ staff and faculty.
- Set up and troubleshoot event, conference and presentation technology on site, including projectors, displays, audio and video conferencing.
- Coordinated technical inventory sent to partner schools through the Office of Technology, from request through delivery and return.
- Authored knowledge base articles, user documentation, troubleshooting guides and onboarding resources adopted as the standard reference, reducing recurring support requests.
- Maintained records and recurring reporting across non-integrated systems, tracing discrepancies to source each term.

IT and Operations Lead (Volunteer) | IQRA Arabic Academy

Jan 2023 - Dec 2024

- Sole technical resource and first point of contact for 100+ end users, handling every request from intake through resolution across software, hardware, device, platform and account access with no escalation path.
- Analyzed support history and found most volume traced to a small set of recurring causes. Built 4 training workshops and 8 recorded sessions targeting them: **repeat support requests fell 80%** and time lost to technical problems dropped from 30% to 10%.
- Raised completion of online assessments 50%** by teaching users the full workflow from access through submission confirmation.
- Administered accounts and access across Microsoft and Google platforms, including provisioning, permissions, MFA, periodic access review and revocation on exit.
- Ran patching and endpoint protection compliance across all managed devices, and delivered security awareness training.
- Organized, tracked and updated technology assets, coordinating device setup, reallocation and retirement.
- Built and maintained the knowledge base: 50+ records under a naming convention with version control.

IT Analyst Intern | eFusion Solutions

Oct 2022 - Jan 2023

- Resolved 30+ Level I and Level II help desk tickets weekly covering Microsoft 365, Windows systems, application errors, network access, account administration and remote desktop connectivity.
- Administered user accounts across 15+ client environments in Active Directory, handling onboarding and offboarding, provisioning, security groups, permissions and login troubleshooting.
- Performed workstation setup, configuration and deployment with hardware and software troubleshooting; configured Cisco switches and deployed virtual servers in VMware.
- Managed tickets from open through close, documenting root cause and resolution, and escalated with reproduction steps and exact error text.
- Monitored endpoint and network health using PRTG, Sophos and Webroot, escalating alerts as required.

EDUCATION

M.S. Cybersecurity | Lewis University | GPA 3.9/4.0

May 2026

B.Tech, Computer Science Engineering (Honors) | JNTU Hyderabad

May 2024

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified in Cybersecurity (CC) - ISC2

Jul 2026

Cybersecurity Defense Analyst - Cisco

May 2026

Technical Support Fundamentals - Google

Sep 2026

Cybersecurity Certificate: Play It Safe - Google

Jul 2026

SC-200: Security Operations Analyst - Microsoft

Scheduled Oct 2026

CompTIA A+

In progress

PROJECTS AND RECOGNITION

IT & Networking Home Lab - Segmented lab covering subnetting, pfSense, DNS and DHCP, firewall rules, Active Directory, VPN, and IDS/SIEM monitoring.

AuditReady AI - Assesses an organization against NIST CSF 2.0, identifies control gaps and tracks remediation to closure with documented evidence.

SideQuest Cup - Deployed web app (Next.js, TypeScript, Vercel) covering triage workflows, uptime monitoring and access review.

TEDx Speaker, TEDxLewisUniversity (Mar 2026) • 3rd Place, Capture the Flame Cybersecurity Competition, UIC (Apr 2026) • National Cyber League, Experienced Bracket (Apr 2026) • Speaker, kcpCON and CornCon (Oct 2026)